

AELITA

PRODUCTION

PRESS RELEASE

Stary Oskol, August 19, 2026

AELITA PRODUCTION Brings Alexander Panov's Meditative Detective Piece "Porfiry" to the "Tochka Cuire" Festival

On October 24 at 19:00, CSI "Byl" (Stary Oskol, Zhukova microdistrict 38, Red Hall) hosts "Porfiry" as part of the "Tochka Cuire" contemporary art festival — a meditative detective piece inspired by Dostoevsky and Akutagawa, produced by AELITA PRODUCTION. Directed by and starring Alexander Panov. Running time — about an hour, 16+.

ABOUT THE PRODUCTION

The murder of an old pawnbroker. No clues. No known motive. The suspects have scattered through a bamboo grove among young Japanese cedars. Meditation. Ikigai. Bushido. Only this will help Porfiry solve the most sinister crime in Russian literature.

"Porfiry" is a mash-up inspired by Dostoevsky's "Crime and Punishment" and the prose of Ryūnosuke Akutagawa: investigator Porfiry Petrovich conducts an inquiry in a space where Russian psychological drama meets Japanese contemplation. The solo production combines detective intrigue with audience interaction and a meditative rhythm.

ABOUT THE DIRECTOR

Alexander Panov is the director and performer of "Porfiry", a resident artist of AELITA PRODUCTION.

REVIEWS

"The show 'Porfiry' was a wonderful intellectual game, full of memes, favourite Akutagawa quotes and elegant Japanese touches, brimming with irony and humour" — Pyotr Semak, actor, Maly Drama Theatre

"For an hour the audience enjoyed a triumph of postmodernism and irony, drawing on homemade haiku and quotes from Hayao Miyazaki's films" — Yulia Batalina, "Novy Kompanyon"

"Wittily quoting social-media memes and clearly relishing himself on stage, the actor switches between deep meditative states and interaction with the hall" — Mila Denyova, "Petersburg Theatre Journal"

ABOUT THE "TOCHKA CUIRE" FESTIVAL

"Tochka Cuire" is AELITA PRODUCTION's annual contemporary art festival at CSI "Byl", Stary Oskol. Its first edition runs October 22–25, 2026: fifteen productions over four days — from the flagship mystery play to physical theatre, performances and a promenade show — plus exhibitions, a business programme and a lecture series.

ABOUT THE VENUE

CSI "Byl" is the first contemporary art centre in the Belgorod region, opened in 2023 in the restored building of the former "Byl" cinema (1982). Two auditoriums — Blue Hall (496 seats) and Red Hall (168 seats) — allow parallel performances.

ABOUT THE COMPANY

AELITA PRODUCTION is a theatre production company founded in 2025 by Ekaterina Abdulova and Konstantin Moshnikov. In under a year of work — more than 10 projects delivered and a presence in 4 Russian cities. The company produces the creation, touring and distribution of productions at the intersection of contemporary theatre, choreography and visual art.

TEAM

Director & performer — Alexander Panov

Second director — Svetlana Nikiforova

Set designer — Alexey Vasilyev

DATE, TIME AND PLACE

October 24, 2026, 19:00

CSI “Byl”, Stary Oskol, Zhukova microdistrict 38, Red Hall

Running time — about an hour · 16+

Tickets: <https://cuire-fest.ru/tickets/show/2c06d654-f6be-4db6-83ce-7de3b9437779>

PRESS CONTACTS

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